

Policies

➊ How to cite SciServer

We at SciServer request that the following be added to the acknowledgement section of any paper or presentation using SciServer Resources, Tools, or Components:

This research makes use of the SciServer science platform (www.sciserver.org).

SciServer is a collaborative research environment for large-scale data-driven science. It is being developed at, and administered by, the Institute for Data Intensive Engineering and Science at Johns Hopkins University. SciServer is funded by the National Science Foundation through the Data Infrastructure Building Blocks (DIBBs) program and others, as well as by the Alfred P. Sloan Foundation and the Gordon and Betty Moore Foundation.

When discussing the SciServer platform within the body of a paper, please cite “SciServer: a Science Platform for Astronomy and Beyond” (Taghizadeh-Popp et al., 2020, arXiv:2001.08619 (<https://arxiv.org/abs/2001.08619>)).

➋ SciServer Data Storage Policy

File Storage

SciServer provides two networked storage pools to store user data that can be accessed and used by all SciServer applications, in particular SciServer Compute: **Storage** and **Temporary**. Within each of these, users can create top level “User Volumes” within which they write data (folders and files), and which can be shared with other users.

- **Storage** pool (10 GB) is permanent, is backed up, and is Quota’d
- **Temporary** pool allows users to temporarily store large datasets, but
 - is shared between users
 - is not backed up
 - is not Quota’d
 - should not be used for permanent storage.

To ensure that **Storage** and **Temporary** storage do not become full, SciServer has introduced the following rules governing the allocation and reclamation of user space:

- SciServer currently allocates 10 GB of permanent space for each user, known as **Storage**.
 - Attempts by users to exceed this allowance will fail.
- SciServer provides a large (measured in TB) shared **Temporary** storage space for all users.

- SciServer reserves the right to delete data – without prior notification – in the *Temporary* pool after a grace period of 72 hours in order to maintain acceptable free space for all users.
- The grace period begins at the creation of the file or folder.
- Modifying a file or folder does not reset the grace period.
- The oldest data files or folders will be deleted first.
- User requests for additional *Temporary* storage or retention time will be considered on a per-user basis.

Database Storage

SciServer provide two storage options for databases that can be used with the SciServer CASJobs application. This follows a similar pattern to the File Storage allocation:

- **MyDB:** This is a private database for each user to store the results of CASJobs queries.
 - These databases are backed up
 - They are permanent
 - Tables can be shared with other users
- **MyScratch:** This is a shared temporary database to support the creation of ‘intermediate’ datasets results from long or large queries, too big to fit into the **MyDB**.
 - This database is temporary and not backed up
 - The data will be deleted after a short retention period

To ensure that **MyDB** and **MyScratch** storage do not become full, SciServer has introduced the following rules governing the allocation and reclamation of user space:

- SciServer currently allocates 0.5 GB of **MyDB** storage for each user.
 - Attempts by users to exceed this allowance will fail.
 - User requests for additional allocation of **MyDB** will be considered on a per user basis.
- SciServer provides 80 TB total of shared **MyScratch** storage space for all users.
 - SciServer reserves the right to delete data in the **MyScratch** database after a grace period of 72 hours.
 - The grace period begins at the creation of the database table.
 - Modifying a table does not reset the grace period.
- Users will be notified by email 24 hours before their **MyScratch** data is deleted.

SciServer’s Data Storage Policy is subject to change. However, SciServer will not delete user data as a result of a policy change that decreases a user’s allocation in the Storage pool.

Users are permitted only one SciServer account. Please do not create multiple accounts to circumvent storage limits. If you need more storage, please request by contacting the SciServer helpdesk (mailto:sciserver-helpdesk@jhu.edu). Violation of this policy may result in your account being suspended or deleted.

SciServer Compute Container Use Policy

SciServer Compute Containers that have not been accessed recently will be permanently removed. At the time of writing, those containers that have not been accessed (by clicking on the container name in the SciServer Compute application (<https://apps.sciserver.org/compute/>)) for 90 days are candidates for removal.

Users are permitted only one SciServer account. Please do not create multiple accounts to circumvent computation limits. Violation of this policy may result in your account being suspended or deleted.

SciServer Non-Commercial Use Policy

Johns Hopkins Information Technology Use Policies